

Places

The urban development consortium first emerged from a partnership between planners in Barcelona, located in Spain, and researchers based in Seoul in South Korea. Their early work focused on comparing coastal resilience strategies across both cities. Soon after, analysts from Cape Town in South Africa joined the initiative, contributing insights on water-scarcity management in rapidly growing metropolitan regions.

As interest grew, the consortium expanded to include specialists from Vancouver in Canada, who brought expertise in sustainable transport networks. Their findings often intersected with studies from Helsinki, the capital of Finland, where cold-climate urban design has long been a priority. Meanwhile, a parallel team in São Paulo, one of Brazil's largest cities, examined how megacities adapt public services to shifting demographic patterns.

The most recent collaborations involve researchers in Melbourne, situated in Australia, who are mapping long-term heat-island effects. They work closely with colleagues in Istanbul, a major hub in Turkey, to compare how historical districts respond to modern infrastructure demands. Although the consortium spans continents, a coordination office in Lisbon, the capital of Portugal, ensures that data from all participating cities flows into a unified global model.